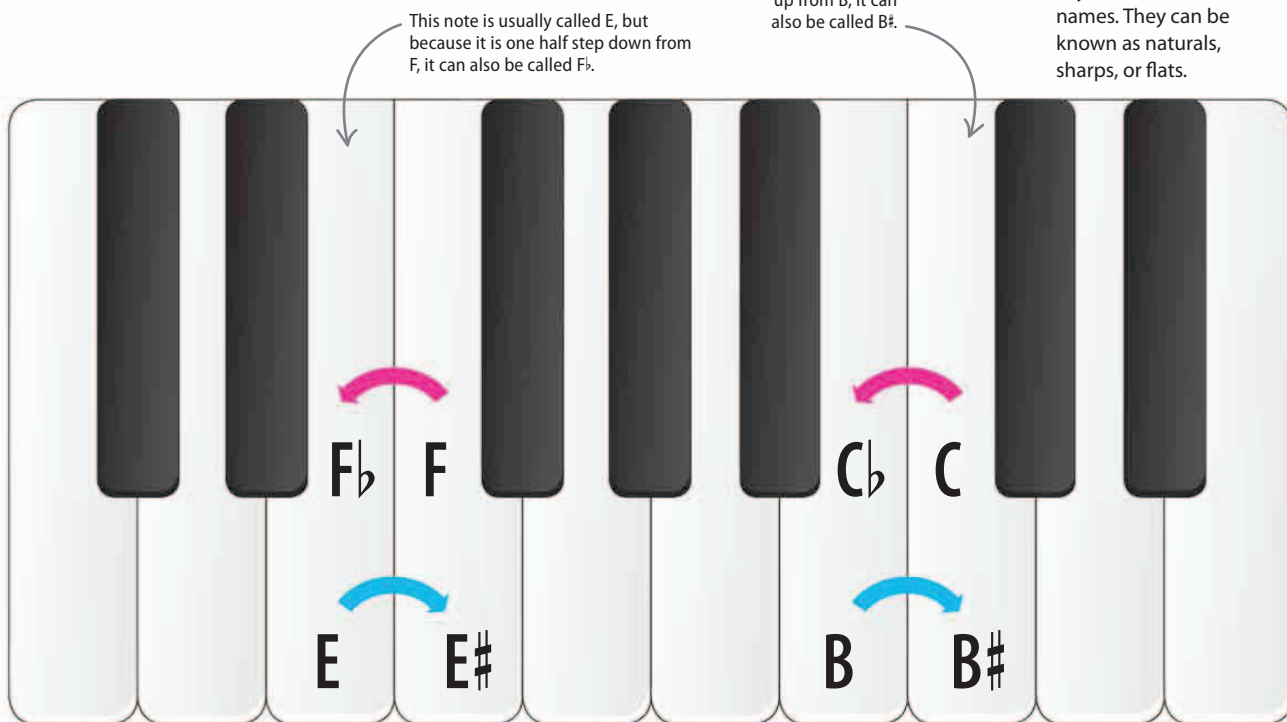


What about white keys?

The white keys immediately next to each other on the keyboard, without black keys in between, can also be called sharps or flats. A white key that is a half step down from another white key is that note's flat, and a white key that is a half step up from another white key is that note's sharp.

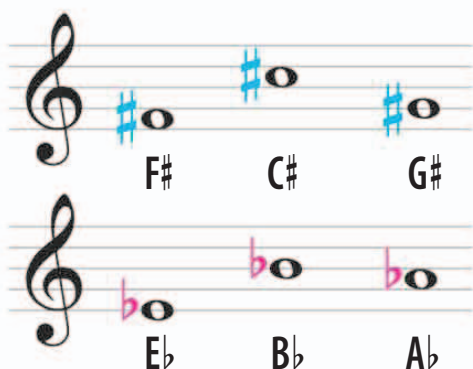


18 ▽ Sharps and flats on white keys

The white keys on the keyboard have different names. They can be known as naturals, sharps, or flats.

On the staff

When sharps and flats are written on the staff, the symbol for the sharp or flat is written just before the note that is sharpened or flattened. The symbol is written on exactly the same line or space of the staff as the note itself.



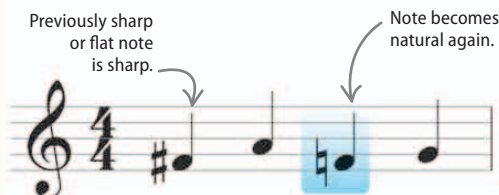
◁ Writing sharps and flats

In music notation, the sharp or flat symbol is written just before the note, on the same space or line as the note, while they are written after the letter name in text.

LOOKING CLOSER

Naturals

A natural cancels a sharp or a flat. The symbol for a natural is only written next to a note if the note was previously sharp or flat. It makes the note return to being a natural.



△ Canceling sharps and flats

Here F $\sharp$ is canceled by a natural symbol, becoming F $\natural$. Flats can be canceled by naturals in the same way.

